

## Healthcare Personnel Influenza Vaccination

|                |                                          |                    |                                                                                                                      |
|----------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Policy Number  | POL-SAF-075                              | Owner / Department | Employee Health / Infection Prevention & Control                                                                     |
| Effective Date | 2023-09-15                               | Version            | 2.2                                                                                                                  |
| Last Revised   | 2026-03-01                               | Next Review        | 2028-03-01                                                                                                           |
| Approved By    | Infection Prevention & Control Committee | Applies To         | All employees, licensed providers, students, volunteers, and contractors with patient or patient-environment contact |

### 1. Purpose and Scope

This policy establishes annual seasonal influenza vaccination for health-care personnel to protect patients and the workforce. It aligns with CDC recommendations for influenza vaccination of health-care personnel and with CMS requirements to track and report personnel vaccination status through the CDC National Healthcare Safety Network (NHSN).

### 2. Vaccination Requirement

- All in-scope personnel are vaccinated annually during the facility influenza campaign (typically October–March) unless an approved exemption applies.
- Vaccine is offered on-site at no cost; externally obtained vaccine is accepted with documentation.
- Vaccination status is recorded in Employee Health and aggregated for CMS/NHSN reporting.

### 3. Exemptions and Masking

Personnel may request a **medical** or **religious** exemption through Employee Health and Human Resources with required documentation.

**IMPORTANT — Unvaccinated personnel (including approved exemptions) must wear a surgical mask in all patient-care areas for the entire declared influenza season. Declination or exemption does not waive the masking requirement.**

### 4. Compliance and Documentation

1. Obtain vaccination or submit an exemption/declination form by the campaign deadline.
2. Employee Health verifies and records status and issues masking requirements to exempt/declining staff.
3. Managers monitor unit compliance; non-compliant personnel are escalated to Employee Health and HR.
4. The facility reports aggregate personnel vaccination coverage to CMS via NHSN for the reporting period.

### 5. Severity & Reporting

Classify and notify per **POL-RM-013**. A nosocomial influenza outbreak linked to unvaccinated personnel with patient death/harm is a **SEV-1**; a unit outbreak or systemic compliance failure is a **SEV-2**; an individual masking lapse or documentation gap is a **SEV-3 / Near Miss**.

| Severity                        | Notify                                                       | Deadline        |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| SEV-1 (catastrophic / sentinel) | Infection Prevention, Employee Health, administrator on call | Within 1 hour   |
| SEV-2 (major)                   | Infection Prevention and Employee Health                     | Within 4 hours  |
| SEV-3 / Near Miss (minor)       | Employee Health via electronic event report                  | Within 24 hours |

## 6. References

- CDC recommendations for influenza vaccination of health-care personnel (ACIP).
- CMS requirements for reporting health-care-personnel influenza vaccination via CDC NHSN.
- POL-RM-013 — Incident Reporting and Event Severity Classification.
- POL-SAF-074 — Employee Tuberculosis Screening and Respiratory Protection.